ALL THE CITY'S A STAGE

PLAY

Ghachar Ghochar *writer Vivek Shanbhag's new play draws up the balance sheet of urbanisation*



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The Kannada writer Vivek Shanbhag's new play *Illiruvudu Summane* was performed for the first time in Bengaluru on July 12. The name, which roughly translates to 'We Are Here Like That Only' or 'We Are Here Incidentally', forms one half of a couplet by Purandara Dasa, the 16th century philosopher-saint and a founding father of Carnatic music. The play was written three years ago, for an arts-and-theatre

INTERVIEW

It's Time to Play Again

Covid might have left theatre crippled, but **Lillete Dubey** *is now helping lead a revival of sorts. From July 19-24, she will be staging five of her plays in Mumbai in a bid to bring back audiences to Prithvi Theatre.*



Q. How does it feel now that theatre is up and running after the long pandemic hiatus?
It feels wonderful. It was like one was living a partial life with something vital missing. For me at least, something that completed my life was gone. I think the major challenge now is to get audiences back into the theatre. There is still a sense of wariness about the virus, about being in an enclosed space with a lot of people, and the uncomfortable aspect of wearing a mask. But we are going to test the waters very soon!

Q. You have five plays showing at Prithvi this month. In some ways, they trace your trajectory–from *Dance Like a Man*, which has been running for more than 25 years, to the latest, *Lockdown Liaisons*. What has the journey been like?
Tough, exhilarating, demanding and deeply fulfilling! We chose a difficult path. To do largely new original Indian plays in English (not big western hits), written by both contemporary writers like Mahesh Dattani, and by theatre legends like Girish Karnad, together with old classics of Vijay Tendulkar and others. New plays require a lot of rewriting